

Newsletter Number 51



FUTURE MEETINGS

Tuesday 27 January in the Old Priory at 2.30pm. Tea and coffee available beforehand
Carl Smith, Leader of the GYBC
Re-development of North Quay and Other Matters

Tuesday 24 February in the Old Priory at 2.30pm. Tea and coffee available before hand
James Wilson, Head of Environment and Sustainability, Environmental Services, GYBC
Improving the Environment in Great Yarmouth

Recent meetings

Tuesday 14 October in the Old Priory
Rob Haslam, Architect and owner of Old Vicarage and Priory.
“Curing Energy Poverty Together”

Rob Haslam said that there were 12 million households in the UK with children and 1million of those houses had energy poverty. 10% of people who were over the age of 75 suffered from energy poverty. There were 44,544 households in the Borough and 17.6% of these suffered energy poverty. Many children were going to school hungry as were some adults.

There are many forms of sustainable energy such as solar with the use of battery storage, wind, and hydrogen. There is geothermal which extracts heat from deep in the ground. He had overseen a project to combine geothermal heat from 34 bore holes 168 metres deep and 600 solar panels for a university in London and since they were installed they have not had to use their boilers.

Rob had suggested such a scheme for Great Yarmouth Minster which would produce excess heat which could be piped to other buildings in the area. He has also suggested similar schemes for other buildings in the town which would feed heat to adjacent buildings. Great Yarmouth had the opportunity of leading this development in the country which would enable people to have heat at cheaper than present day prices. It could be done in conjunction with reviving old and empty buildings helping to produce community heating and he had access to finances of £30M-£50M to service these developments.

Tuesday 18 November in the Old Priory
Stuart Burgess, Archaeologist and Historian.
The Rows of Great Yarmouth

There were over 145 Rows stretching from east to west and if they were put end to end they would measure a total of 7 miles in length. The first Rows were mentioned in 1198 and by 1391

they were encircled by a wall on three sides with the River Yare enclosing them to the west. They were long, narrow alleyways and the buildings were made of flint, stone, brick or wood. The floors of The Rows were made of cobblestones from the beach. People of many trades lived and worked here and they all helped each other.

Great Yarmouth was a front line town against the French, Spanish and Dutch and because of the narrowness of The Rows one man could have defended a Row. Most of the wealth came from the herring and at one time there were 200 smoke houses in the Rows. It was not until the mid 1800s that houses were allowed to be built on the sands outside the town wall.

Because of the narrowness of The Rows the Trollcart was designed which had its wheels beneath it and it could be stood upright. Sanitation was not good with the passage ways acting as open sewers and at one time it was recorded that 44 people shared one toilet.

Many of the town councillors were wealthy merchants and as they became more wealthy they built large houses at either end of The Rows. There was no space for gardens and most vegetable were bought in the very large Market Place. At one time there were 655 traders in the town and 52 ice cream men, most of whom came from Italy.

Around the start of the 19th century some of the Rows were condemned and were pulled down and others were replaced by roads such as Regent Street. During the Second World War much of the town was bombed and afterwards the council pulled down many of the remaining Rows which were thought to be not fit for living in.

ANTI-SOCIAL BEHAVIOUR AND FLY-TIPPING

GYBC is planning to form a task force to include additional police officers to deal with anti-social behaviour and fly-tipping, to keep streets clean and tidy and increase the levels of recycling. Paul Wells, GYBCs holder for Environment and Sustainability, Licensing and Waste, says the council is committed to improving the look and feel of the town and to develop pride in it.

The Scheme would cost £1.15M over three years and fly-tipping costs the council £180,000 yearly. The task force would also deal with empty and unkempt properties.

RE-DEVELOPMENT OF NORTH QUAY

This 10 acre site between the River Yare and North Quay is to be redeveloped as a retail outlet for 70 shops, with a 120 bed hotel, food and beverage places and an IMAX cinema with four screens which will double up as a conference centre. There will be green spaces, a riverside walk, houses and a carpark for 915 cars. It is anticipated that 2 million people will be drawn to the area yearly and this will help other businesses and hotels in the town. It is hoped that building will commence in 2 years time employing 500 people and it will open in Easter 2030. The project is being headed by Rioja Estates who are leaders in this type of development and the construction will be carried out by Willmott Dixon who aim to spend up to 40% of the budget within 20 miles of the project.

GREENING UP GREAT YARMOUTH.

We are very keen to green up the town and have been awarded £10,000 to help us do this. We will be starting on the Market Place, King Street and Regent Street and will be upgrading the garden in front of the Priory School. Part of our time will be working with school children and growing on plug plants in the East Norfolk Sixth Form College greenhouse. In addition Ann Hacon and Angela Powley have secured a grant from Tony

Wright's constituency fund to help them in their work. If you are interested in helping out in these projects please let me know.

CIVIC VOICE

Civic Voice is an umbrella organisation for civic societies but recently it has run into financial difficulties. At its recent AGM it was decided that a group of volunteers would continue to run it until it could be run on a more sustainable financial model. I think there is much to be gained by having Civic Voice which enables us to gain from the experience of other civic societies.

FUTURE ACTIVITIES

We are planning to run our annual competition for shops, businesses, and market stalls and the competition for secondary schools to find the best Junior Community Ambassador. Please let me know if you are interested in helping with these projects.

MEMBERSHIP

Renewal of membership fees should have been made by now and it would help us if you could encourage family or friends to become members. Membership forms and details are on our Website: www.civicsocietygy.co.uk

I do hope you will have a lovely Christmas and let us continue to improve Great Yarmouth and encourage people to take pride in it.

Best wishes,

Hugh Sturzaker
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